

STAND UP, SPEAK OUT - THE PRACTICE AND ETHICS OF PUBLIC SPEAKING



Stand up, Speak out - The Practice and Ethics of Public Speaking

Anonymous

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Source Publication Date: 2013

Harvesting Date: May 2019

Last Edit Date: June 2020

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APA Style 7th ed.

Anonymous (2020). *Stand up, Speak out - The Practice and Ethics of Public Speaking*. LibreTexts

About the Authors

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Jason S. Wrench (EdD, West Virginia University) is an associate professor in the Communication and Media department at the State University of New York at New Paltz. Dr. Wrench specializes in workplace learning and performance, or the intersection of instructional communication and organizational communication. His varied research interests include communibiology, computer-mediated communication, empirical research methods, humor, risk/crisis communication, and supervisor-subordinate interactions. Dr. Wrench regularly consults with individuals and organizations on workplace communication and as a professional speech coach for senior executives.

Dr. Wrench has published five previous books: *Intercultural Communication: Power in Context, Communication, Affect, and Learning in the Classroom* (2000, Tapestry Press), *Principles of Public Speaking* (2003, The College Network), *Human Communication in Everyday Life: Explanations and Applications* (2008, Allyn & Bacon), *Quantitative Research Methods for Communication: A Hands-On Approach* (2008, Oxford University Press), and *The Directory of Communication Related Mental Measures* (Summer 2010, National Communication Association). He is currently working on five other book projects for [Unnamed Publisher](#), Kendall-Hunt, Allyn & Bacon, and Praeger. Dr. Wrench was the editor of the *Ohio Communication Journal* from 2005 to 2007 and has served as an associate editor for *Communication Research Reports* from 2007 to 2010. Furthermore, Dr. Wrench has published over twenty research articles that have appeared in various journals: *Communication Quarterly*, *Communication Research Reports*, *Education*, *Human Communication*, *Journal of Homosexuality*, *Journal of Intercultural Communication*, *Southern Communication Journal*, *The Source: A Journal of Education*, and *The NACADA Journal* (National Association of Campus Advising). Many of his writings are available on his website at <http://www.JasonSWrench.com>.

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Anne Goding (MS, Eastern Washington University) is a lecturer in the Communication and Media department at the State University of New York at New Paltz. Ms. Goding specializes in the intersections of intercultural communication, storytelling, and public communication. From 1981 to 1992 Ms. Goding worked as a teacher for the Medicine Chief of the Bear Tribe Medicine Society in Spokane, Washington. Ms. Goding taught outdoor summer programs for adults, which included Native American philosophy; ceremonial etiquette in native societies; earth rituals; traditional women's studies emphasizing Native Americans; the Sacred Pipe emphasizing Ojibwe and Paiute-Arapaho traditions; the sweat lodge ceremony and its symbolism emphasizing Ojibwe tradition; and the Vision Quest, a traditional rite of passage for contemporary people. From 1986 to 1989, Ms. Goding also worked as codirector of Bear Tribe Publishing Company.

In 1994 Ms. Goding received a mini-grant from Eastern Washington University Foundation for the development of a teaching package in visual presentation for public speaking. She has presented workshops on public speaking for a range of audiences. Ms. Goding has previously published the article "How Institutional Meanings Displace the Real Environment (Revisiting Rio)" in the *International Journal of Communication*.

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Danette Ifert Johnson is Professor of Communication Studies at Ithaca College. She previously taught at West Virginia Wesleyan College and Texas Tech University. Danette completed her undergraduate studies in history and speech communication at West Virginia Wesleyan College and earned an MA in educational psychology from West Virginia University and an MA and PhD in communication studies from Northwestern University.

Over her almost twenty-year teaching career, she has taught courses ranging from introductory Business & Professional Communication and Public Speaking to graduate courses in Quantitative Research Methods and Interpersonal Influence. She has written over thirty published articles and book chapters, including articles in *Communication Education*, *Communication Research*, *Western Journal of Communication*, and *Communication Teacher*. Dr. Johnson has been recognized for her teaching with West

Virginia Wesleyan's (WVWC) Community Council Outstanding Faculty Award and WVWC's Honors Faculty Member of the Year. In 2009, she was recognized as a Distinguished Teaching Fellow of the Eastern Communication Association (ECA). She is also a recipient of ECA's Past President's Award for early to mid-career scholarly achievement and service to the organization. Dr. Johnson is a past executive director of ECA and is presently first vice president-elect of the organization.

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Acknowledgments

We want to acknowledge our various college/university campuses that have provided us much needed support and goodwill during this entire project. Without our academic homes, projects like these would never take flight.

We would like to acknowledge Janice Walker Anderson for her help in writing the initial draft of the chapter on communication apprehension. Your help with this draft was immensely helpful and your spirit definitely touched the entire project.

We would like to acknowledge the multitude of people who have helped us along the way. To Elsa Peterson, our developmental editor, thank you for your wisdom and edits as we made our way through this project. To Jenn Yee and KB Mello, our editorial supervisors, thank you for your patience. You helped shepherd this project even when we couldn't see the light at the end of the tunnel. Lastly, thank you to Michael Boezi for taking a chance on our writing team and staying with us throughout the entire project. Your leadership is apparent in each page of this book. PS: Thanks again for a great meal and conversation at the Guided Otter!

Thank you to all of the reviewers who helped us along the way. Your guidance and insight helped reign us in when necessary and helped us create the amazing textbook you now see in front of you.

- Jodie Mandel, College of Southern Nevada
- Emily Brandenberger, Kutztown University
- Harlene Adams, California State University, Sacramento
- Bridgette Colaco, Troy University
- Jason Warren, George Mason University
- Helen Prien, Ferrum College
- Kevin Backstrom, University of Wisconsin Oshkosh
- Zachary Justus, California State University, Chico
- J. M. Grenier, Middlesex Community College
- Brent Adrian, Central Community College–Grand Isle
- Braze Brickwedel, Tallahassee Community College
- Clark Friesen, Lone Star College
- Bryan Crow, Southern Illinois University, Carbondale
- David Bashore, College of the Desert
- Diana Cooley, Lone Star College–North Harris
- Chad D. Malone, Ivy Tech Community College–Columbus, Indiana Campus
- Burton St. John III, Old Dominion University
- Steven D. Cohen, University of Maryland
- Deborah Bridges, University of Houston, Central Campus
- Cameron Basquiat, California State University, Chico

Lastly, thank you to all of the students who have taken our public speaking classes in the past. Teaching is an exercise of experimentation and our past students have definitely been our guinea pigs at times. The cumulated information in this book comes from our own personal experiences with public speaking, the academic literature, and our previous students. Without our previous students, we wouldn't have the knowledge to write a textbook like this one.

Preface

Public speaking in the twenty-first century is an art and a science that has developed over millennia. In a world that is bombarded by information, the skill set of public speaking is more important today than ever. According to an address given by Tony Karrer at the TechKnowledge 2009 Conference, the *New York Times* contains more information in one week than individuals in the 1800s would encounter in a lifetime. Currently, the amount of information available to people doubles every eighteen months and is expected to double weekly by 2015. In a world filled with so much information, knowing how to effectively organize and present one's ideas through oral communication is paramount.

From audience analysis to giving a presentation, *Stand Up, Speak Out: The Practice and Ethics of Public Speaking* will guide students through the speech-making process. We believe that it is important to focus on the practical process of speech making because we want this book to be a user-friendly guide to creating, researching, and presenting public speeches. While both classic and current academic research in public speaking will guide the book, we do not want to lose the focus of helping students become more seasoned and polished public speakers. We believe that a new textbook in public speaking should first, and foremost, be a practical book that helps students prepare and deliver a variety of different types of speeches.

In addition to practicality, we believe that it is important to focus on the ethics of public speaking from both a source's and a receiver's point of view. In 2006 Pearson, Child, Mattern, and Kahl examined the state of ethics in public speaking textbooks. Specifically, the researchers used the National Communication Association (NCA) Credo for Ethical Communication to guide their study of ethics in public speaking textbooks. Ultimately, the researchers focused on eight specific categories of public speaking ethics content areas: freedom of speech, honesty, plagiarism, ethical listening, ethical research, hate words, diversity, and codes of ethics. As a whole, the top ten public speaking books varied in their degrees of exposure to the various ethical issues. We believe that using the NCA Credo for Ethical Communication as the basis for discussing ethics within this book in addition to the latest research in ethics and communication will help students see how ethics can be applied to the public speaking context. The emphasis on ethics in communication is very important across the field, so a public speaking textbook that completely integrates ethical issues instead of sidelining them will be a welcome addition. All four of the coauthors on this text have conducted research on the topic of communication ethics and written about how ethics is important in every facet of our communicative lives.

Overall, we believe that the combination of practicality and ethics will present a new perspective on public speaking that will be welcomed by the field. We believe this book will be both intellectually stimulating and realistically applicable.

References

Karrer, T. (2009, January 29). New work literacies and e-learning 2.0. Presentation given at TechKnowledge-09, Las Vegas, Nevada.

Pearson, J. C., Child, J. T., Mattern, J. L., & Kahl, D. H., Jr. (2006). What are students being taught about ethics in public speaking textbooks? *Communication Quarterly*, 54, 507–521. doi: 10.1080/01463370601036689